

DAR AL-ULUM MONTREAL

Annual Report

2024 *and* 2025

Two years of growth in Islamic education for the Muslim children of Montreal, reported with gratitude to the donors, families and teachers who made it possible.

Henri-Bourassa and Saint-Laurent, Montreal, Quebec

Fiscal years ended December 31, 2024 and December 31, 2025

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\$837,336

Total revenue in 2025
up 74% from \$480,804 in 2024

\$485,436

Donations received in 2025
up 129% from \$212,306 in 2024

\$532,606

Invested in teachers and staff in 2025
up 61% from \$331,578 in 2024

40%

Share of 2025 costs covered by tuition and
service fees
the rest is carried by donors

All amounts in this report are in Canadian dollars and are drawn from the organization's year-end accounting records for the calendar years 2024 and 2025. The figures are unaudited.

Message from the Founder

As Salam Alaykum wa Rahmatullahi wa Barakatuh.

Alhamdulillah, the two years covered in this report are the years in which Dar Al-Ulum Montreal stopped being a small project and became an institution. In June 2021 we opened with five students under the direct mashwarah of my teacher, Hazrat Mufti Ebrahim Desai, may Allah elevate his rank. By the end of 2025 the same idea was serving well over a hundred families across two sites, with a full Hifdh program, a full time and part time Aalimiyah program, an academic preparatory stream, and a homeschool support service recognized for ministry evaluations. None of that belongs to me. It belongs to the teachers who carry the classrooms every day, to the parents who trusted us with their children, and to the donors who decided that this city needed a place like this and paid for it to exist.

I owe you honesty as much as gratitude, because your money is an Amanah. In 2024 we closed the year almost exactly at break even, with a deficit of \$3,513 on revenue of \$480,804. In 2025 revenue grew by 74% to \$837,336, and donations more than doubled, yet expenses grew faster. We hired more teachers, we took on more space, and we absorbed the real cost of educating a much larger student body. The year ended with a deficit of \$44,162 and a loan of \$45,000 that bridged the gap. Tuition now covers roughly forty cents of every dollar it costs to teach a child here. The remaining sixty cents comes from you.

We have never turned a student away for financial hardship and, InshaAllah, we never will. That policy is only possible because of the people reading this report. In a province where the space for Muslim children to learn their deen keeps narrowing, every classroom we keep open is a form of resistance and, I pray, a Sadaqah Jariyah for everyone who had a share in it.

The pages that follow set out exactly what came in, exactly what went out, and where we stand. Read them, question them, and then help us carry this into 2026.

Jazakallah Khayra.

(Mufti) Mirza-Zain Baig, CSAA

Founder and Principal, Dar Al-Ulum Montreal

Who we are

Dar Al-Ulum Montreal is an Islamic educational institution founded in June 2021 to give Muslim children in Quebec a rigorous religious and academic education without leaving their city or their families.

Our story

The school began with five students and a conviction that a student of knowledge should not have to choose between a seminary abroad and no seminary at all. It was established under the guidance of the late Hazrat Mufti Ebrahim Desai and has grown in four years to serve more than 145 students across two Montreal sites, at Henri-Bourassa and Saint-Laurent, supported by a team of roughly thirty teachers and staff.

How we are organized

Dar Al-Ulum Montreal operates as a registered charity in Canada and is recognized as a 501(c)(3) organization in the United States, so gifts from donors on both sides of the border are receipted. The institution is governed by a board and its accounts are kept on a calendar year basis.

Our commitment

No child has ever been refused a place at Dar Al-Ulum for financial reasons. Tuition is set well below the true cost of a seat, and the difference is met by the community. That gap is the single most important number in this report and it appears on page 10.

What we offer

Hifdh al-Quran

Full time and part time memorization of the Quran with daily revision and tajweed.

Aalimiyah

A full time and part time program of classical Islamic sciences, including Arabic, fiqh, hadith and tafsir, taught in the Hanafi tradition.

Preparatory and academic stream

Academic instruction that runs alongside religious studies so that graduates leave ready for university and for leadership.

Homeschool support and evaluations

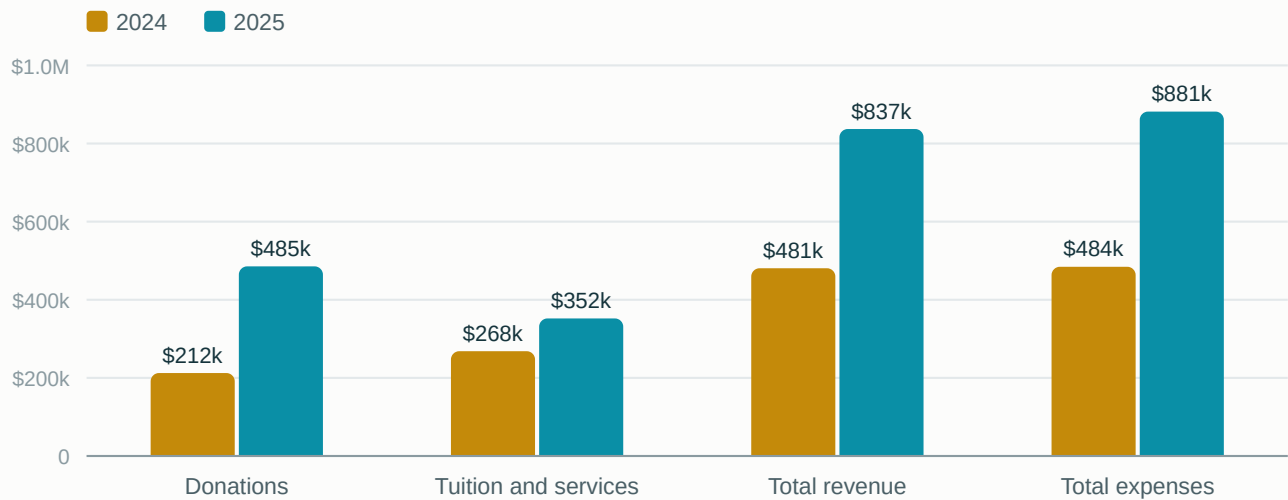
Curriculum support and ministry evaluation reports for families who homeschool, recognized for the purposes of Quebec reporting.

Community and social activities

Summer programs, student outings and community events that keep the students connected to one another and to the wider Muslim community.

Two years at a glance

Revenue grew by 74% between 2024 and 2025. Expenses grew by 82% over the same period, because the school hired, expanded and served far more students than the year before.



Revenue and expenses, 2024 and 2025, in Canadian dollars.

	2024	2025	CHANGE
Donations and fundraising	212,306	485,436	129%
Tuition and educational services	268,498	351,901	31%
Total revenue	480,804	837,336	74%
Teachers, staff and payroll	331,578	532,606	61%
General operating expenses	152,740	348,893	128%
Total expenses	484,317	881,499	82%
Net result for the year	(3,513)	(44,162)	

The 2024 accounts record payroll under salaries and wages and the 2025 accounts record it under payroll and fees. Both are shown here as teachers, staff and payroll. Change is shown where both years have a positive balance.

Where the support came from

Two streams fund the school: tuition and service fees paid by families, and donations given by the community. In 2024 the two were nearly equal. In 2025 donations became the larger stream for the first time.



Share of total revenue by source.

Donations

Donations rose from \$212,306 in 2024 to \$485,436 in 2025, an increase of 129%. In 2024 the accounts separated cash and cheque gifts of \$52,866 from online gifts of \$159,440, so three quarters of giving already arrived through the online channel. In 2025 all giving was recorded under a single donations account.

This growth is the reason the school could expand in 2025 without collapsing under the cost. It is also the clearest measure of how much the community has come to rely on Dar Al-Ulum and how much it trusts it.

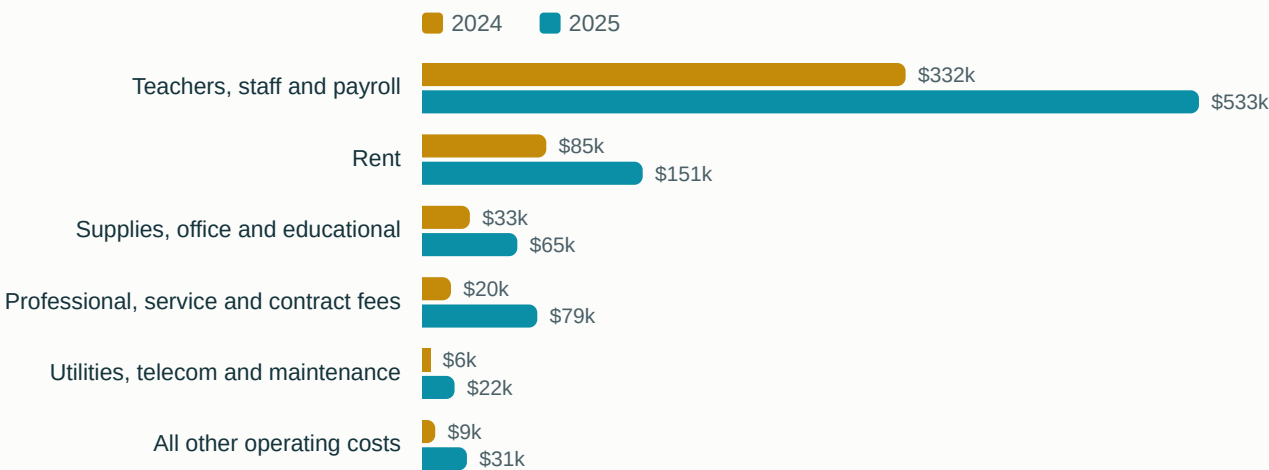
Tuition and educational services

Fee revenue rose from \$268,498 to \$351,901, an increase of 31%. In 2024 the largest single line was the full time Hifdh and Aalimiyah program together with home services at \$232,888, followed by part time Aalimiyah at \$18,247, part time Hifdh at \$8,094, preparatory services at \$5,585 and book sales at \$3,684.

In 2025 educational and religious services brought in \$344,401 and homeschool evaluation services added \$7,500, a new line reflecting the growth of the evaluation program.

Where the money went

Every dollar the school spends goes to one of a small number of things: the people who teach, the rooms they teach in, the materials the students use, and the services that keep a growing institution compliant and running.



Expenses by category, 2024 and 2025. Categories group the line items in the statement of operations on page 11.

People first

Payroll is the largest cost in both years and it is where the growth went. Salaries and wages of \$331,578 in 2024 became payroll and fees of \$532,606 in 2025, an increase of 61%. Payroll was 60 cents of every dollar spent in 2025. A school is its teachers, and the community's donations paid for more of them.

Space

Rent rose from \$85,274 to \$151,318, an increase of 77%, as the school grew into more space across its two sites. Rent was 17 cents of every dollar spent in 2025.

Supplies and services

General and office supplies together rose from \$32,867 to \$65,355 as classrooms were equipped for more students. Professional, consulting, service contract and subcontracting fees rose from \$19,915 to \$79,016, and 2025 also carried \$10,000 in evaluation fees tied to the homeschool evaluation program, \$1,000 in permits and licences and \$617 in publicity.

Everything else

Utilities, telephone and internet, maintenance, insurance, bank and card fees, student meals, outings and social activities made up the balance, \$53,204 in 2025 against \$14,685 in 2024.

The year 2024

2024 was a year of consolidation. The school ran on \$480,804 of revenue against \$484,317 of expenses and closed within \$3,513 of break even.

Revenue

Families paid \$268,498 in tuition and service fees, which covered 55% of the year's costs. Donors gave \$212,306, with \$159,440 arriving online and \$52,866 by cash and cheque.

Expenses

Payroll of \$331,578 and rent of \$85,274 together accounted for 86% of spending. Office supplies of \$20,488, general supplies of \$12,378 and professional fees of \$19,915 were the next largest items.

Year end

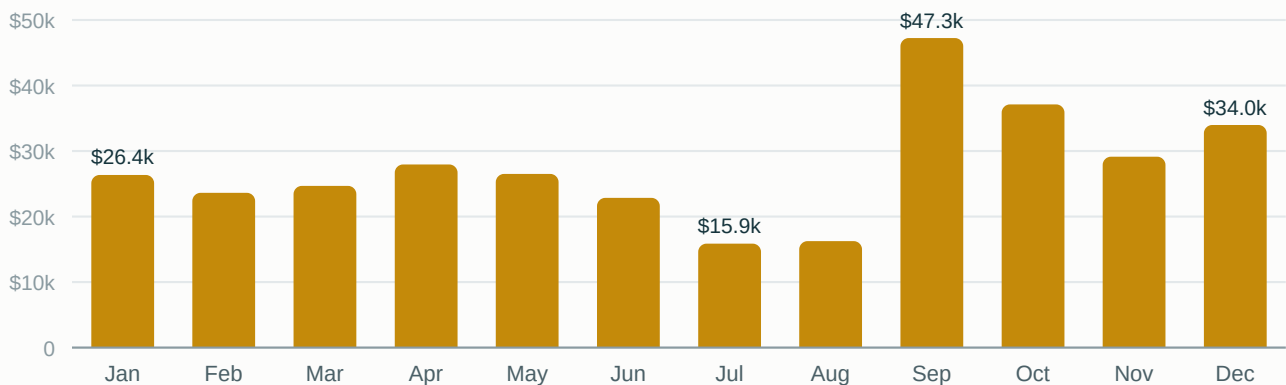
The school ended 2024 with \$5,488 in the bank and \$5,753 owing to suppliers. Accumulated funds moved from \$3,247 at the start of the year to a small negative balance of \$265 at the close.

Payroll through the year

Monthly payroll shows the rhythm of a school year. It ran near \$25,000 a month through the winter and spring, eased over the summer, and then stepped up sharply in September when the new academic year opened with more teachers and more students. The fall months set the base from which 2025 grew.

Looking back

Break even on a budget of nearly half a million dollars, with no reserve and no borrowing, was an achievement for a school in its third full year. It was also a warning. The September step up in payroll shows that the institution was already committing to a larger 2025 before the funding for it existed.



Payroll paid by month in 2024, in Canadian dollars. Total \$331,578.

The year 2025

2025 was a year of expansion. Revenue reached \$837,336, expenses reached \$881,499, and the year closed with a deficit of \$44,162 that was bridged by a loan.

Revenue

Donations of \$485,436 became the school's largest source of funds, at 58% of revenue. Tuition and educational services contributed \$344,401, and the homeschool evaluation program added \$7,500 in its own right.

Expenses

The school invested \$532,606 in teachers and staff, \$151,318 in space, and \$59,541 in general supplies as classrooms were fitted out for a much larger student body. Service contracts of \$40,269 and professional and consulting fees of \$34,810 reflect the administrative, legal and accounting work that a larger institution requires. Maintenance rose to \$8,521 and heating and electricity to \$6,851 with the additional space.

What the deficit means

Fee revenue covered 40% of the cost of running the school in 2025, down from 55% in 2024. That is not a sign of weakness in the fee base, which grew by 31%. It is the arithmetic of a policy: the school grew faster than it raised tuition, and it kept its door open to every family regardless of means.

The gap between what families paid and what the education cost was \$529,598. Donors closed \$485,436 of it. The remaining \$44,162 was carried forward as a deficit and financed by a \$45,000 loan.

Year end

The school closed 2025 with \$572 in the bank, no supplier balances outstanding, and a loan of \$45,000. Accumulated funds stood at a negative \$44,428.



How the \$881,499 cost of running the school in 2025 was met.

Financial position and the road ahead

Where we stand

AT DECEMBER 31	2024	2025
Cash in bank	5,488	572
Owed to suppliers	5,753	0
Loans	0	45,000
Accumulated funds	(265)	(44,428)

The school holds no buildings, vehicles or investments on its books. Everything it receives is spent on education in the same year. That is by design, and it is also why the institution has no cushion. Two consecutive deficits have left accumulated funds at a negative \$44,428 and the loan must be repaid.

The number that matters

With more than 145 students, the cost of a year of education at Dar Al-Ulum in 2025 was approximately \$6,079 per student, while fee revenue came to approximately \$2,427 per student. Every student at the school is therefore sponsored by the community to the extent of roughly \$3,652 a year, whether the family knows it or not.

Priorities for 2026

The first priority is to repay the \$45,000 loan and to rebuild a reserve so that payroll never again depends on the timing of the next campaign. The second is to lift recurring monthly giving, because a school that grew its costs by 82% in a year cannot be run on year-end appeals alone. The third is to keep the institution's commitment that no child is refused for lack of means, which is only sustainable if the sponsorship gap on the left is funded deliberately rather than by accident.

How you can help

A monthly gift is the most valuable thing a supporter can give, because it turns an unpredictable deficit into a planned budget. Sponsoring a student for a year, or a portion of a year, directly closes the gap described on this page. Zakat and Sadaqah are accepted and applied in accordance with the Shariah, and the school issues official receipts in both Canada and the United States.

To give, or to discuss sponsoring a student, a classroom or a program, please contact the administration of Dar Al-Ulum Montreal at either site. Every contribution, of any size, is received as an Amanah and reported back to you in the next edition of this report.

Statement of operations

For the years ended December 31, 2024 and December 31, 2025. Unaudited. Canadian dollars. Line items follow the organization's chart of accounts for each year.

Year ended December 31, 2024

REVENUE	
Cash & cheque donations	52,866.44
Online donations	159,440.01
Prep educational services	5,585.29
Hifz part time	8,093.56
Hifz and Aalimiyah full time and home services	232,888.45
Aalimiyah part time	18,246.70
Books	3,683.80
Total revenue	480,804.25
EXPENSES	
Salaries and wages	331,577.51
Professional fees	19,914.57
Credit card fees	3,228.47
Insurance	620.00
Transaction and bank fees	546.69
Office supplies	20,488.43
General supplies	12,378.37
Rent	85,273.56
Electricity	1,953.49
Maintenance and repairs	423.48
Telephone and internet	2,529.88
Meals, representation and travel	3,469.73
Gas	675.51
Social activities	1,237.33
Total expenses	484,317.02
Deficiency of revenue over expenses	(3,512.77)

Year ended December 31, 2025

REVENUE	
Donations	485,435.50
Evaluation revenue	7,500.00
Educational and religious services	344,400.85
Total revenue	837,336.35
EXPENSES	
Payroll and fees	532,605.91
Service contracts	40,269.45
Professional and consulting fees	34,810.40
Publicity and promotion	617.07
Permits and licences	1,000.00
Insurance	675.59
Transaction and bank fees	4,306.55
Office and educational supplies	5,814.03
General supplies	59,541.34
Subcontracting fees	3,936.00
Computer and informatics	174.70
Evaluation fees	10,000.00
Rent	151,317.62
Electricity and heating	6,851.21
Maintenance and repairs	8,520.96
Telephone and internet	5,122.24
Meals, representation and travel	10,626.50
Gas	1,849.36
Social activities	2,494.38
Donations given	965.42
Total expenses	881,498.73
Deficiency of revenue over expenses	(44,162.38)

Statement of financial position

As at December 31, 2024 and December 31, 2025. Unaudited. Canadian dollars.

	2024	2025
ASSETS		
Cash, chequing account	5,464.41	532.90
Cash, savings account	23.70	39.34
Total assets	5,488.11	572.24
LIABILITIES		
Accounts payable	5,753.49	0.00
Loans	0.00	45,000.00
Total liabilities	5,753.49	45,000.00
ACCUMULATED FUNDS		
Balance, beginning of year	3,247.39	(265.38)
Deficiency of revenue over expenses for the year	(3,512.77)	(44,162.38)
Balance, end of year	(265.38)	(44,427.76)
Total liabilities and accumulated funds	5,488.11	572.24

Notes to the financial information

Basis of preparation. The figures in this report are taken from the organization's year-end income statements, balance sheets and trial balances for the calendar years 2024 and 2025 as maintained in its accounting system. They have not been audited or reviewed by an independent accountant. Amounts in the narrative sections are rounded to the nearest dollar and percentages are computed from the unrounded figures.

Revenue classification. In 2024 donations were recorded in two accounts, cash and cheque donations and online donations, and educational revenue was recorded across five program accounts. In 2025 the chart of accounts was simplified to a single donations account and two educational accounts, educational and religious services and evaluation revenue. Comparisons in this report group the accounts of each year into donations and tuition and educational services.

Payroll. Payroll is recorded as salaries and wages in 2024 and as payroll and fees in 2025. Monthly figures on page 8 are the payroll disbursements recorded in the 2024 general ledger and reconcile to the annual total.

Loans. The 2025 balance sheet carries a loan of \$45,000 classified as a current liability. No loans were outstanding at December 31, 2024.

Capital assets. No capital assets are recorded on the balance sheet in either year. Premises are rented.